

Smart gear choices for travel

AMAZON INDIA'S ZEBHA KHAN UNPACKS TECH CHOICES OF INDIAN TRAVELLERS IN 2025

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It's early April in Mumbai, and the airport lounges are already starting to hum with that particular kind of energy – the kinetic buzz of summer travel. Family reunions, monsoon getaways, digital detoxes, and off-grid retreats are once again reshaping the way Indians think about their holidays – and the choice of gear they bring along on the ride.

At the heart of this seasonal shift in travel habits lies a quieter transformation in the way Indian consumers are increasingly tech-ing up for their trips. It's no longer just about power banks and selfie sticks. Today's traveller is browsing GPS-enabled smartwatches, noise-cancelling earbuds, LTE-capable fitness bands, action cams that can survive a 100-foot dive, and AI-curated shopping lists. It's powering an ecosystem of tech gadgetry tailored for everything from Himalayan treks to Goan siestas.

To decode the top travel tech trends of the season, I interviewed Zeba Khan, Director, Consumer Electronics at Amazon India. What emerged was a revealing snapshot of how tech is quietly reengineering the Indian vacation – adding comfort, confidence, and a fair bit of content creation along the way. Edited excerpts follow:



ZEBHA KHAN
Director, Consumer Electronics,
Amazon India

Q What are the top-selling tech gadgets that cater specifically to travel and holiday needs of Indian consumers?

Zeba Khan: As

Indian consumers prepare for summer travel, their focus on convenience, upgrades, and connectivity is fueling a surge in tech purchases. Here are some of the top-performing gadgets currently available on Amazon India for travel enthusiasts:

■ **Headphones:** A must-have for any travel journey, we are seeing an emerging trend where cus-

tomers are preferring premium headphones with Active Noise Cancellation, Long Playtime (>50 hours), and instant pairing. We continue to focus on providing customers with a wide selection from top brands and have also launched premium products like the Sony LinkBuds Fit, Noise Masterbuds, and boAt Nirvana Space, all of which have features suited to modern travel.

■ **Portable Speakers:** With outdoor trips and getaways on the rise, portable speakers are booming and emerging as a fast-growing segment under audio. We see customers preferring features like deep bass, which are available in products like the boAt Stone Ignite Series and JBL Flip 5.

■ **Cameras:** Travel is fueling the passion for content creation. As more Indians take to professional photography, mirrorless cameras are seeing strong demand. These come with full-frame & APS-C sensors, prime and zoom lenses, and are extremely lightweight – making them travel-friendly for both beginners and pros.

■ **Smartwatches:** Perfect for tracking vacation activities such as treks, swims, and sightseeing.